

alone as that brings down the volume level a bit.

The best part is that this player comes with an adapter and rechargeable batteries, so just plug the adapter into a wall socket, put in the rechargeable batteries, and it charges quickly enough to last you for a long jogging trip, or the hour-long journey to office, and more. You can use

Price: Rs 4,500
Contact: Moon Computers
Phone: 022-2653390
E-Mail: sales@moonindia.com
Web site: www.moonindia.com

two regular AA alkaline batteries to keep it alive for around six-seven hours easily. All this for a price of only Rs 5,000, which is half of that of other popular CD MP3 players.

SPECIFICATIONS:
120 second skip buffer; reads CD-Rs and CD-RWs; rechargeable battery included

Napa DAV315		A-
Performance	★ ★ ★ 1/2	
Build Quality	★ ★ ★ ★	
Value for Money	★ ★ ★ ★ 1/2	
Features	★ ★ ★ 1/2	
OVERALL	★ ★ ★ ★	



“The Napa DAV CD-MP3 hits the sweet spot with skip-free playback and a reasonable price tag”

Aliasgar Pardawala
Reviewer

Soltek SL-85SD Motherboard

Packed with promise

The Soltek SL-85SD is Soltek's solution for users who would like to go in for a

Pentium 4-based system based on the 845 chipset using ordinary SDRAM. It supports Pentium 4 processors with the Socket 478 interface. There is support for up to 3 GB of PC-133 SDRAM through three DIMM slots. The packaging of the product was very good and it came with a detailed manual and a driver CD along with the unique RedStorm overclocking utility. With this utility,

you can easily overclock the machine without fears of frying the processor. What this utility does is that it automatically overclocks the processor through 1 MHz increments and checks for system stability. You can then choose to run the system at the higher frequency.

The benchmark scores were, nevertheless, nowhere close to what you can generally expect from a machine using RDRAM, and considering the fact that the processor interface adopted was Socket 478, this motherboard would ideally be meant for the 2.0 GHz and above range of processors from Intel. Pairing such a fast processor with SDRAM is truly bottlenecking the

Price: Rs 6,500
Contact: Rank Data Products
Phone: 022-3873168
E-mail: rankdata@vsnl.com

processor to a great extent and is not recommended. Nevertheless, it is a feature-packed board with onboard sound and an onboard Promise IDE RAID controller, which supports RAID 0 or RAID 1.

SPECIFICATIONS:
3 DIMM slots supporting SDRAM PC 133; AGP 4x slot; 6 PCI slots; CNR slot; 4 USB Ports and integrated IDE RAID controller
Benchmarks: 55.7 fps (normal mode), 55.2 fps (high quality mode), 53 fps (max settings) in *Quake III* v1.30; 66.2 in Content Creation; drive index of 22009 in SiSoft Sandra; 29 MBps sequential read, 6 MBps random read; 39 MBps sequential write; 8 MBps random write speed; 8 ms average access time

Soltek SL-85SD		B+
Performance	★ ★ ★ 1/2	
Build Quality	★ ★ ★ ★	
Value for Money	★ ★ ★ 1/2	
Features	★ ★ ★ ★	
OVERALL	★ ★ ★ 1/2	

Sony CDU5211 (52x CD-ROM Drive)

High price, average performance

With 56x drives now almost becoming the standard, this drive at 52x speed is a tad slow and gave below average performance in almost all the tests.

The SiSoft Score of 1660 logged by this drive was way below as compared to other 52x drives, which normally score in the range of 2000 for this test. The audio ripping was also not very fast; it took a little under 48 seconds to rip the innermost track of the audio CD which was 72.83 MB in size.

The only thing going for

this drive however was the random access time. It scored a neat 51 ms, which is a better score when compared to other competing drives. This is just another drive with very little to talk about in terms of performance. The pricing too is a little on the higher side.



SPECIFICATIONS:
128 KB buffer; single and multisession compatible
Benchmarks: 1660 in Ziff-Davis CD Winbench 99; 2784 Kbps sequential read speed

Sony CDU5211		B
Performance	★ ★ ★	
Build Quality	★ ★ ★	
Value for Money	★ ★ ★	
Features	★ ★ ★	
OVERALL	★ ★ ★ 1/2	

Price: Rs 2,200
Contact: Rashi Peripherals
Phone: 022-8260258
E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com
Web site: www.rptechindia.com